ISSUE 06

Tools for Your Toolkit

Justice-involved job seekers, the AI Toolbox & a fresh look at The Hub

KEVIN WESTWOOD · WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026 · 3 MIN READ

01

November — Breaking Barriers: Supporting Justice-Involved Job Seekers



Shannon McCracken

Presented by Shannon McCracken, Career Services Consultant

Justice involvement can create significant and often misunderstood barriers to employment. Criminal and police records, gaps in employment, stigma, employer screening practices, conditions of release, and challenges related to housing, transportation, or community reintegration can all affect a job seeker's path forward. In this practical 60-minute Breaking Barriers session, employment service professionals will explore how to support justice-involved job seekers with confidence, dignity, and an employment-focused approach.

Participants will explore

- Common employment barriers experienced by justice-involved job seekers
- How stigma and assumptions can influence service delivery
- How to have respectful conversations about justice involvement without turning an employment appointment into an interrogation
- Criminal and police record checks and what employment professionals should understand
- Supporting conversations about disclosure and employment gaps
- Identifying realistic employment opportunities without unnecessarily limiting a job seeker's options

- Preparing job seekers for interviews and employer questions
- Building practical Employment Action Plans and connecting job seekers with appropriate community supports
- Approaches to employer engagement that focus on skills, suitability, and opportunity

This session is designed for frontline employment professionals, case managers, employment advisors, job developers, and others supporting job seekers through Employment Ontario and community employment services.

> ***Breaking barriers begins with seeing the job seeker before seeing the record.***

Breaking Barriers: Supporting Justice-Involved Job Seekers

Presenter	Shannon McCracken, Career Services Consultant
Dates	Tuesday, November 17 or Thursday, November 19 · 1:00 PM
Location	Zoom

Registration for Breaking Barriers: Justice-Involved Job Seekers

02

The AI Toolbox: Work Smarter in Employment Services



Shannon McCracken

Looking for fresh ways to personalize your support? Join this lunch and learn to explore how AI can help you create individualized job seeker tools, tailor resumes,

prepare for interviews, and streamline everyday tasks. Take away practical prompts and ideas you can put to work — with privacy and professional judgment at the centre. No AI experience needed!

Choose the session that works for you.

The AI Toolbox: Work Smarter in Employment Services

Format	Lunch & Learn
Dates	Thursday, November 26 or Thursday, December 3 · Noon–1:00 PM
Location	Zoom

Registration for The AI Toolbox

03

Explore The Hub @PATH: Another Resource in Your Toolkit



Kevin Westwood

Have you visited The Hub @PATH's refreshed website? Built with case managers and employment professionals in mind, it brings together practical resources and learning opportunities to support your day-to-day work with job seekers. Explore self-paced courses, browse our live training catalogue, check upcoming events, revisit past newsletters, and access the job board — all in one place.

The website is an additional way to connect with The Hub's support. Use it to explore a topic, find professional development for your team, or start a conversation with us. Our team continues to offer case consultations, group case conferences, and guidance tailored to the situations you're working through.

Visit The Hub @PATH and bookmark it for your next question, learning opportunity, or team discussion.

Visit The Hub @PATH

04

Occupational Therapy Assessments



Sri Prasad

Are you or a job seeker you support unsure about their physical or cognitive abilities? Would you like more information on these factors to ensure the job seeker's path to employment is a good fit? Our Occupational Therapist can complete Functional Capacity Evaluations (FCEs) and cognitive assessments to provide you with more information — as well as consultations to assist job seekers in managing injury/illness symptoms, discuss accommodations, and more!

Send in a referral to The Hub's Occupational Therapist any time.

Submit an OT referral

Building Capacity. Amplifying Success.

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